

THE GRAND CANYON

This great gash through the arid landscape of Arizona is 6,000 ft (1,800 m) deep in places. It was formed by the Colorado River cutting down through rocks that were being pushed up by the moving plates of Earth's crust. The canyon exposes about 40 layers of sedimentary rock. The Redwall Limestone in the foreground was laid down in a tropical sea more than 330 million years ago.